11.1 Plant Life Cycles

4th Grade Science · Video: Plant Life Cycles: Oak Trees (Edpuzzle Originals)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

Watch Out for Acorns!

Acorns fall in huge groups. There can be hundreds or even _____.

During some years, one single oak tree can make over _____ acorns.

Our big question: Why do oak trees need to make so many acorns?

The Acorn's Secret

When we put an acorn in the ground, after some time up sprouts a little _____.

Inside every acorn is a _____.

When that seed sprouts, it is the first step of the oak tree's _____.

Four Steps of a Life Cycle

The sprout grows to a little _____ and all the way to a fully grown tree.

This change marks the second stage of the life cycle, _____.

Next, the tree grows enough to enter the third phase, _____.

Reproduction is when the oak tree makes more oak trees, or _____.

Some acorns will grow into new _____ trees over time.

Finally, the grown tree enters the last stage, _____.

The four steps are birth, growth, reproduction, and death. All _____ follow these steps.

Why So Many Acorns?

_____ love to eat acorns.

Opossums, blue jays, quails, raccoons, and wood ducks eat acorns too. Eaten acorns will not grow into trees.

Some acorns fall in a _____ spot that does not get enough sunshine to grow.

Oak trees make acorns because it is how they _____.

They make so many because not all of them will _____. Some get eaten instead.

Show What You Know: Pine Trees

A pine tree follows the same four steps of the life cycle as the oak tree.

Inside the pine _____ are seeds.

The sprouting seed shows the _____ stage of the life cycle.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
life cycle	the steps a living thing goes through: birth, growth, reproduction, and death
seed	the part inside an acorn or pine cone that can sprout into a new plant
sapling	a young tree
reproduction	when a living thing makes more of its own kind
organism	any living thing, like a plant or an animal

Key Takeaways

• All plants and animals follow four steps: birth, growth, reproduction, and death.

• Oak trees make lots of acorns because many get eaten or cannot grow.